

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3



♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, East plays the ♠ 9, South the ♠ 5. You assume East has signaled you to continue ♠ s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick East plays the ♠ 3 and South the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both East and South are now void of ♠ s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, East won't bother ruffing, South **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠ . East will ruff and South will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of North's ♠ J. As you can see, South would have been able to discard a loser on that

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3  
 ♥ Q J 10 7  
 ♦ 8 5 2  
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5



♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              |             | 2NT          |

Pass      3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

**Board 5**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ A 6 5  
♥ Q 10 6 4  
♦ K 7 2  
♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3  
♥ 8 7  
♦ Q 6 5  
♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ 8 7 2  
♥ J 9 5 2  
♦ A 8 4 3  
♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4  
♥ A K 3  
♦ J 10 9  
♣ A K Q J

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1 ♣          |
| Pass         | 1 ♠          | Pass        | 2NT          |
| Pass         | 3NT          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by South |              |             |              |